Section 504 materials access

By Laura Elizabeth Hand

Use for a file, video, form, or course-site task.

Choose one rating for each question. Skip items you still need to check. Record how you tested a verified item or why it does not apply. Save a copy after filling.

What did you review? Include the version.

Audience, format, or test setup

Reviewer (optional)

Review date (optional)

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01 / Structure and reading order

Can someone using a screen reader follow the material in order?

In the learner's copy, check the title, language, headings, lists, and table headers where present. Read through with a screen reader to check the order.

WCAG 1.3.1, 1.3.2, 2.4.2, 3.1.1

Barrier found
Something got in the way of the task.

Needs a retest
Some checks passed or a fix needs testing.

Worked in my test
Record how you ran the check in the learner's version.

Does not apply
Record why this check is outside this review.

Rating

Choose a rating

Test evidence or reason

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02 / Images and charts

Can learners get the important information without seeing the image?

Check that text equivalents convey what learners need from each meaningful visual and that decorative images are skipped.

WCAG 1.1.1

Barrier found
Something got in the way of the task.

Needs a retest
Some checks passed or a fix needs testing.

Worked in my test
Record how you ran the check in the learner's version.

Does not apply
Record why this check is outside this review.

Rating

Choose a rating

Test evidence or reason

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03 / Audio and video

Can learners get the important information from the media in an accessible way?

Check captions, transcripts, audio description, and keyboard access to the player as applicable. Compare a sample against the audio and visuals.

WCAG 1.2.1-1.2.5, 2.1.1

Barrier found
Something got in the way of the task.

Needs a retest
Some checks passed or a fix needs testing.

Worked in my test
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Does not apply
Record why this check is outside this review.

Rating

Choose a rating

Test evidence or reason

04 / Keyboard and focus

Can someone finish the task with just a keyboard?

Use Tab, Shift+Tab and standard control keys from start to finish. Look for visible focus, sensible order, and no traps.

WCAG 2.1.1, 2.1.2, 2.4.3, 2.4.7

Barrier found
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Some checks passed or a fix needs testing.

Worked in my test
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Does not apply
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Rating

Choose a rating

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05 / Contrast, color and zoom

Is the information still clear without relying on color, or when enlarged?

Measure contrast and test zoom and reflow where applicable. Check text, important controls, and whether color is the only cue.

WCAG 1.4.1, 1.4.3, 1.4.4, 1.4.10, 1.4.11

Barrier found
Something got in the way of the task.

Needs a retest
Some checks passed or a fix needs testing.

Worked in my test
Record how you ran the check in the learner's version.

Does not apply
Record why this check is outside this review.

Rating

Choose a rating

Test evidence or reason

06 / Links, forms and errors

Can learners tell what a link or field does and recover from an error?

Follow links and try submitting a form with an error using a keyboard and screen reader. Check names, instructions, and error messages.

WCAG 2.4.4, 3.3.1, 3.3.2, 4.1.2

Barrier found
Something got in the way of the task.

Needs a retest
Some checks passed or a fix needs testing.

Worked in my test
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Does not apply
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Rating

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Test evidence or reason

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07 / The version learners receive

Does the file or course page actually work in the version learners open?

Open the final version from the learner's view. For PDFs, check text selection, tags, and any fields. Follow required downloads or third-party steps.

Format-specific checks and manual testing

Barrier found
Something got in the way of the task.

Needs a retest
Some checks passed or a fix needs testing.

Worked in my test
Record how you ran the check in the learner's version.

Does not apply
Record why this check is outside this review.

Rating

Choose a rating

Test evidence or reason

08 / Help and equivalent access

Can a learner get timely help and complete the same learning task?

Find the way to request access or report a barrier. Check who responds and what usable option learners have while a fix is pending.

Section 504 equal-access context

Barrier found
Something got in the way of the task.

Needs a retest
Some checks passed or a fix needs testing.

Worked in my test
Record how you ran the check in the learner's version.

Does not apply
Record why this check is outside this review.

Rating

Choose a rating

Test evidence or reason

Scope: This rubric records selected accessibility checks in the version and setup reviewed. A separate review is needed to determine legal compliance.

Revision priorities

Sources and related tools

Curriculum Review Studio - Laura Elizabeth Hand

34 CFR Part 104 · Department of Education regulations

Section508.gov · PDF testing and remediation

U.S. Department of Education · technology accessibility

W3C · WCAG 2.1 success criteria

U.S. Department of Justice · ADA Title II web and mobile rule